



Ask Cortana what your friends are doing

While you are using your Xbox One, you may ask Cortana to check what your friends are doing. Just ask “Hey Cortana, is (friend’s name) online?” or “What is (friend’s name) doing?”. She’ll tell you whether your Xbox Live friend is online and what he is doing. For example, “watching TV”.



Create custom Google Now commands

If you are bored with the Google-offered limited Google Now commands, you may create your own commands to enhance the functionality of the voice assistant. To do this you’ll need two apps - “AutoVoice” (free app) and “Tasker” (paid app). Download and install the required apps from the Google Play Store. After you are done installing both the apps navigate to Settings > Accessibility > AutoVoice Google Now Integration > Turn on > OK.

After this, open Tasker app > hit the “+” button located at the bottom-right corner > Event > Plugin > AutoVoice Recognized > hit the “pencil” button > Speak Filter. Now say the custom command you want to create > choose the Voice Command you just said > hit the “tick button” located at the top-right corner.

Once you have created the custom command, you’ll have to associate the action for that command. Hit the back button > tap “New Task +” > tap the “tick button” > tap the “+” button > select the action from the given list, and if your action doesn’t appear in the given list you



Tap “Event” to create a new profile as Plugin

may search for it > select the action > provide an action to it > Exit Tasker.

Your custom Google Now command is ready to be executed. Just say “Ok Google” followed by your custom command to execute it.



Make your own Amazon Echo using Raspberry Pi

Amazon Echo is an amazing device. Unfortunately, it is not officially available in India yet. If you want Amazon Alexa to be the part of your living room you can make your own using a Raspberry Pi and some hardware you can find in your home. It is a lengthy procedure but not at all complex. Just follow the guide at <http://digit.in/GuideAEcho>.



Control Echo-Pi using your smartphone

If you have built the Amazon Echo using Raspberry Pi, you know it doesn’t wake up to the “Alexa” command. Pressing a button on the Echo-Pi every time isn’t convenient. To deal with this, you can use your smartphone installed with Alexa

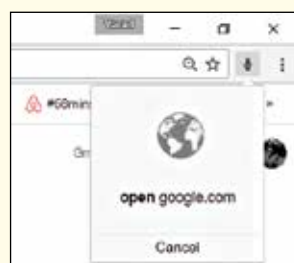
companion app. As Echo-Pi offers nearly all the features from the original Echo, you’ll also be able to use the companion app to voice control Alexa from your phone.



Control Google Chrome using voice commands

Why type URLs when you can just call them? Adding voice commands to Google Chrome is easy and reliable. Once added, it will be one of the most extensively used features. To make Chrome listen to your commands, you’ll need an extension. Although there are many voice commands extensions available, we will recommend “Voice Actions for Chrome” extension as it is more reliable than others. Add this extension to Chrome from <http://digit.in/VAChrome>.

After adding, a small microphone icon will be placed next to the settings button. Click on it and say your command. You can ask it to “go to [website]”, “switch to [tab title]”,



A window acknowledging your command will pop-up.

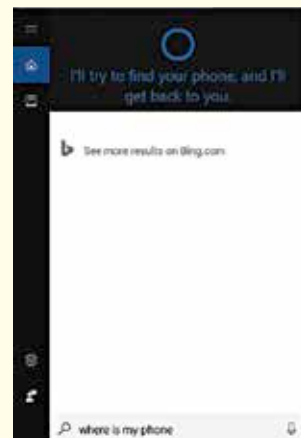
“pictures of [topic]”, “calculate [expression]”. Rather than manual access each time you want to use it, go to “chrome://extensions/” > scroll to the end of the page > Keyboard shortcuts > add a shortcut to “Voice Actions for Chrome” extension > OK. At least now it’s assigned to a shortcut.



Let Cortana automatically remind you of your commitments

Cortana on Windows 10 is updated with a cool new feature that will automatically remind you to do things that you mentioned in email. This latest feature is handy if you rely on Outlook or Microsoft 365 for mail. To do this, first sign in to Cortana using your Microsoft account, go to Notebook > Permissions > check “Communications History”. Go back to Notebook > Connected Services > turn on Outlook and/or Microsoft 365.

Once you have enabled this, Cortana will scan through your emails to automatically create a reminder based on your communication. Just ask Cortana “show my reminders” and it will give you the list of things that you have committed to.



Cortana will remember your promises



Use voice commands to install Windows 10

The “Creators Update” for Windows 10 is going to bring a cool feature in April that lets you install a fresh copy of Windows 10 assisted by Cortana. This means you go through the operating system installation using your voice.